

whatweretheythinking.com

www.anotheruselesswebsite.co.uk

OK. We discovered there are a lot of sites out there that label themselves as 'useless', but this one takes the cake. There really is nothing up there on the site!

Of course, there is *something*. It's all text and a couple of screenshots, and it goes like this: "This site is basically about nothing. You can't buy anything or play games or look at dirty pictures or read a dull blog..."

Fair enough. But the site's creators also have a plan, as in the following: "As the site has no real content, my challenge is to see just how much interest we can generate."

So what were they thinking? How did they expect the site to generate traffic? Did they pepper the source code up with very interesting keywords? There's also a "How can I help" section, where one is urged to spread the news of the existence of the site via word of mouth and more. But why *would* one want to promote their site for them? Soul-searching questions.

The site's creators say the site has been mentioned on istockphoto.com and jamsarts.com, and that they've been receiving more hits as a

result. Now what were *they* thinking? We mean istockphoto and jamsarts: why did they bother to mention this site? We'll never get to figure that one out, unfortunately.

Now here's the most interesting part: since 22 August 2003, the site has received 18,915 hits at the time of going to print. We wonder *how*.



.XXX OKAY

ICANN Approves Adult TLD

It's been in the coming (no pun intended) for quite some time now, but the plan for a .sex TLD (Top-Level Domain), amongst others has finally been approved. As it turns out, it's not to be .sex, but .xxx. The Internet's primary oversight body, ICANN (Internet Corporation for Assigned Names and Numbers) approved a plan on June 1 to set the stage for pornographic Web sites to use new addresses ending with .xxx. ICANN said it would begin negotiations with ICM Registry, run by British businessman Stuart Lawley, to iron out technical issues and prices for the new Web addresses.

Adult-oriented sites, a \$12 billion (Rs 52,200 crore) industry, could begin buying addresses with the .xxx TLD

as early as fall or winter depending on ICM's plans, ICANN spokesman Kieran Baker said. The new pornography suffix was among 10 under consideration by ICANN, which also recently approved .jobs and .travel domains.

ICM contends, rightly we may say, that .xxx Web addresses, which it plans to sell for \$60 (Rs 2,600) a year, will protect children from online smut if adult sites voluntarily adopt the suffix, so filtering software used by families can more effectively block access to those sites.

But it's in that 'voluntarily' that the problems lie. "It will further help to protect kids," said John Morris, staff counsel at the Washington-based Center for Democracy and Technology. Morris, however, predicted some adult sites will choose to buy .xxx addresses, but that others will continue to use .com. ■

Compiled by Aditya Kubler,
Ram Mohan Rao and
Renuka Rane

Blog WATCH

Our hodgepodge of blog postings this month has it all—from online resources on scale spaceship modellers to buying a gaming machine and other geeky ramblings

Disconnected Life
<http://disconnectedlife.weblogs.us/>

Nvidia, TWIT and G4

I plan on grabbing the new nVIDIA card later this month. I hear that the new 7000 series are coming out this month and the price of the 6800 I want will drop considerably then.

Twit... This Week in Tech! Yes they know the acronym spells twit and they call people twits who watch it... I guess it's clever for nerds. It's honestly a great podcast show. In case you don't know what that is, it's a Web radio broadcast that you can download. Weekly, the guys from the old screen savers (Pat, Leo, Yoshi, Kevin) and some times other lesser known techies from the show, have an hour long broadcast. Basically, it's the screensavers radio show. So for this I love it. I missed it when G4 (which apparently stands for girls, gaming, gadgets, and gear) castrated the show then beat it with a bat 'til all the fanboys cried. I find it is fun to listen to it while I work on my 3D studio max stuff or just surfing the net for something in particular.

1000 Degrees Below Zero
<http://biohazard11.free.fr/>

Techo-Starship modeller/Web resource

Here's an enormous Web resource for scale spaceship modellers. I'm not one, as I'm cheating and working 3D most of the time. These guys take days (months) with

real materials when I can drop a few volumes with my favourite CG (Computer Graphics) package. I've also found there a guy who has made the Alien IV's Betty from scratch. And his looks better than mine.

AdSense Digest
<http://adsense-digest.blogspot.com/>

Alternative traffic sources

I had close to 33,000 clicks in May and around 600,000 AdSense impressions. My average pay per click comes roughly less than 30 cents or so. Unique visitors 187,000 according to my awstats. Roughly 80% of my traffic referrals come from 7 major universities (4 American, 2 Canadian, and 1 Swedish) who included link to my site in various journal/article references and abstracts on their pages. I assume that most of my traffic is comprised of students.

Techbook
<http://sandeep.weblogs.us/>

PyS60 Pre-Alpha links fixed on forum Nokia

A couple of days back, Christopher Schmidt was trying out the pre-alpha release of Python for Series 60, and was surprised the camera module was not working on his 6600 (the camera module is not supported on 3650, but is supported on 6600 and upwards). Well, the reason was apparently a broken link on Forum Nokia's download page... it's fixed now.